

Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Students read Roman, Norse, and Eastern mythology, Dickens' A Christmas Carol, and a selection of short stories and fairy tales written or collected in the 19th century.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grades 5-6

About Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.



Placement & Combining Tips

About Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Suitable for hungry 4th graders. A Christmas Carol and some stories and tales shared with Grades 7-8.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	The Age of Fable South American Jungle Tales Russian Fairy Tales A Christmas Carol Short Stories & Folktales

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 5-6				
Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6		General Lit.: Grades 5-6		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ Read the preface and introduction of *The Age of Fable* for background information about myths and the rationale for reading them.

☐ Print "Age of Fable Glossary" for easy access during lessons. Find the link in Quick Links below.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ *The Age of Fable* (Term 1) is best as a read-aloud or assigned as a stretch book for independent reading after the first few lessons are done together. Vocabulary may be difficult to understand, but can be comprehended in context. Reference the glossary in Quick Links as needed. These stories reference imaginary creatures and ancient deities. It is a good idea to think ahead about how you might explain these characters if your students ask.

☐ *Black Ships Before Troy* (Term 2) and *Nearer My Freedom* (Term 3) are great books for written narrations and more independent reading. However, since Homer's famous epic is all about the famous siege of Troy and Equiano's book is a slave narrative, they have some hard and gory parts throughout, which teachers may wish to preview or read with more sensitive students.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6



The Age of Fable



South American Jungle Tales



Russian Fairy Tales



A Christmas Carol

Short Stories & Folktales



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

∞ [Age of Fable Glossary](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 1

Adventures of Aeneas and Dido

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

Virgil wrote the Aeneid between 29 and 19 B.C. We will be reading stories and poetry from this epic work this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.31 p.207-213 "We have followed" - "to the Sibyl"

• COMPOSITION - Illustrate & Caption
Phineus and the Harpies or another scene.

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 2

Elysium and the Sibyl

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32 p.213-221 "As at the" - "in number less."

• COMPOSITION - Act Out
The meeting of Aeneas and Dido in the land of the dead

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 3

Introduction to Infant Rome

Materials: Age of Fable

→ RECAP: WHAT DO YOU REMEMBER ABOUT HOW THE UNDERWORLD WAS DESCRIBED IN THE LAST CHAPTER?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 p.221-230 "Aeneas, having parted" - "along the main."

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 4

Pythagoras

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.34 p.230-248 "The teachings of" - "were no more."

→ VIEW

Here is a bust of Pythagoras.

∞ Image Link: Pythagoras

• COMPOSITION - Illustrate & Tell
The death of Osiris or another scene.

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 5

Origin of Mythology & The Minerva of the Parthenon

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.35 p.241-249 "Having reached the" - "fame have immortality."

→ VIEW

Here is one artist's image of Jupiter and a Roman statue of Minerva.

∞ Image Link: Jupiter

∞ Image Link: Minerva

• COMPOSITION - Expository
Tell at least three theories on the origins of mythology.

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Term 1

WEEK 6 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 6

Modern Monsters

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.36 p.250-256 "There is a" - "these sacred fires?"

WEEK 7 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 7

Eastern Mythology & Siva

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.37 p.256-264 "Our knowledge of" - "Quiloa and Melind."

∞ Image Link: Brahma

∞ Image Link: Vishnu

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 8

Loki and His Progeny

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

In the last several years, the popularity of Marvel comic movies has revived the popularity of mythological characters like Thor and Loki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.38 p.264-269 "The stories" - "long into Niffleheim."

• COMPOSITION - Descriptive
Describe Thor.

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 9

Thor's Visit to Jotunheim

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.39 p.269-275 "Once upon a" - "a verdant plain."

→ VIEW

Look at this runestone, which was carved during the Viking age. The three figures in the center are Odin (with the spear), Thor (with the hammer), and Freyr (with the sickle).

∞ Image Link: Runestone of Norse Mythology

• COMPOSITION - Written
Retelling
Thor's Visit to Jotunheim

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 10

The Death of Baldur & Ragnarok

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

It is amazing that these rune stones still can be seen today. Most were engraved during the Viking age, making them around 1,000 years old.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.40 p.276-282 "Baldur the Good" - "by the Northmen!"

WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 11

The Druids

→ INTRO

It is hard to believe some festivals we read about still occur in Scotland

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Term 1	
today.	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.41 p.282-288 "The Druids were" - "but witness mine!"	
WEEK 12  25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i>	
→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
Questions will come from: Age of Fable	

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 25

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ INTRO

A Christmas Carol is a novella, which is longer than a short story but shorter than a novel. It was published on December 19, and the first edition sold out by Christmas Eve, making it an immediate success. Like much of Dickens' writing, the story is a commentary on the social problems of his era, such as poverty, child welfare, and poor working conditions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 Beginning to "closed it with a bang"

- Why do you think Scrooge dislikes Christmas so much?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See extra helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to. Feel free to move reading this book closer to Christmas.

• IMPORTANT DATES

A Christmas Carol published (1843 AD)

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Life In A Victorian Workhouse

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 26

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

How would you describe Scrooge so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-21 "The sound resounded" - "Upon the instant" (end of stave one)

* Why does Scrooge try so hard to explain away Marley's ghost?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: How A Christmas Carol Became A Holiday Classic

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 27

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 Beginning of Stave two - "Upon a winter's night"

* What was Christmas like when Scrooge was young?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: 10 Things To Know about Charles Dickens' Christmas Carol

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 28

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What mood was Scrooge in when we left off? Notice how his mood changes through stave two.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-39 "In came a fiddler" - end of Stave two

* Why were the scenes with Belle so painful for Scrooge?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Why Read Charles Dickens?

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 29

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did the Ghost of Christmas Past show Scrooge?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Charles Dickens home tour

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Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.40-51 Stave three - "Blushed to hint at such a thing"	
WEEK 6 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 30 Materials: A Christmas Carol → RECAP What did Scrooge learn by visiting the Cratchit family? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.51-64 "At last the dinner" - end of Stave three * What do you think the children Ignorance and Want represent?	• EXTRA HELPING ∞ Video Link: Dickens London
WEEK 7 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 31 Materials: A Christmas Carol → RECAP What ghosts have visited Scrooge so far? Who do you think will visit next? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.65-76 Stave four - "there is your father at the door"	• EXTRA HELPING ∞ Video Link: The Story of A Christmas Carol and Victorian England
WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 32 Materials: A Christmas Carol → RECAP What do you think will happen next? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.76-89 "She hurried out" - end of stave five. → VIEW (OPTIONAL) ∞ Video Link: How A Christmas Carol Perfectly Demonstrates 5-Act Structure (Note that this is the same structure as many of Shakespeare's plays.)	
WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

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Examination

Term 1

- In writing or picture, describe a scene from the adventures of Aeneas OR the story of Isis and Osiris.
- Describe Ragnarok in words or pictures.